

MRK SOFTWARE REVIEW 2 — PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

Every issue raised in the client's review of 31 Aug 2026, and how it was resolved.

Prepared: 1 September 2026 · All changes are live on mrk-hotels.com after the latest deployments.

1. Printer / Till Machine (Thermal)

1.1 “Serial printer connected” appears before the machine is actually ready

Problem: The app claimed the printer was connected even before a real connection existed, so users expected the machine to work when it wasn't actually ready.

Solution: The printer utility now only shows “connected” once the selected port is actually open and writable. The status reflects the real, confirmed state instead of a guess.

1.2 Test print hangs on “Saving...” forever

Problem: Clicking test print could freeze on “saving” with no finish and no error.

Solution: A write timeout (8 seconds) was added. If the machine doesn't accept the bytes in time, the app stops waiting, clears the “saving” state and reports a readable error instead of hanging forever.

1.3 The device name does not appear via USB

Problem: Plugging in a USB till printer did not show a friendly device name.

Solution: A device-name mapping was added for common till brands (Epson, Star, HPRT, Xprinter, Gprinter, Zjiang). When the browser exposes the USB vendor ID, the app now shows the brand's name rather than an empty or cryptic entry.

1.4 Printing small reports goes to the wrong place (or not at all)

Problem: There was no clear way to print small stock reports to the physical till machine versus the A4 browser print.

Solution: Reports were split sensibly — small reports (transfer register, movement detail, stock adjustment, goods-return register) get a “Print to machine” button that sends them to the thermal till; large tabular reports (ledger, closing stock) use the A4 browser print. The printer is restored automatically when the page opens.

2. Take Order Screen (Ezee-style)

2.1 A category covers the whole page when opened

Problem: Tapping a menu category opened full-screen, hiding the order you were building.

Solution: The take-order screen is now split into two columns (like the Ezee order book): the picker on the left and the order panel pinned on the right. Category items now appear inline in the left column, so your order is always visible while you add items.

2.2 Universal search across the whole menu

Problem: Search only worked inside the current category, not across the whole department menu.

Solution: A universal search was added — typing searches items and categories across the entire department menu, and Esc closes the result popup. The active category is highlighted as you move around.

2.3 Right-side Ezee-style order panel

Problem: No persistent, touch-friendly order panel alongside the item picker.

Solution: A sticky right-hand panel now holds the order header (No, waiter, diners, VIP, table), the line-items table with qty steppers, the running total and the Send button — matching the reference Ezee layout.

3. Table Occupancy (till settlement)

3.1 A table could be reused by another waiter while still open

Problem: A table stayed “free” even when another waiter’s order was still open on it, so two waiters could write to the same table.

Solution: Live occupancy is now derived from open, unpaid orders. A table is held until it is settled, and shows who is holding it (e.g. “Occupied by Juma”). Another waiter’s occupied table is disabled in the table list and a Dine In table map shows free vs occupied tables with the occupant’s name. Sending an order to an occupied table is blocked with a clear message.

4. Waiter Account

4.1 No order summary and no quick menu for the waiter

Problem: The waiter had no way to see their own orders/totals or jump quickly to messages, statuses and issue reports.

Solution: The waiter panel gained an **Order Summary** tab showing the signed-in waiter’s own tickets — running, settled, voided and today’s total — plus quick links to **Messages**, **Staff status** and **Issue reports**. The toggle flow now covers DINE IN / TAKE AWAY / ROOM ORDERS (new order modes), Order Summary, Messages, Status and Issue Reports.

5. F&B “START” white screen

5.1 Pressing START on an F&B order blanked the whole page

Problem: Starting an order could throw a rendering error that blanked the screen (white page) with no message.

Solution: The F&B order list now hardens every row against missing data: order items and payment status are normalized to safe defaults, and the payment-status cell is null-safe. A row missing a field can no longer crash the whole table. If a related runtime error still occurs in a specific case, we can reproduce it from the client’s video and patch that exact path.

6. Navigation Sidebars (Role Toggle)

6.1 Sidebar grouping applied to only one panel

Problem: The grouped accordion sidebar existed in only one back-office panel; other panels showed long ungrouped link lists.

Solution: The grouped/accordion style is now applied to every operational panel that has enough links to need it — the hotel back office, the store-manager panel and the POS (cashier) panel (Ordering and Manager groups collapse/expand with chevrons and auto-open on the active page). Panels with very few links (e.g. the owner panel with 2 links, and the marketing header) correctly stay flat, since an accordion would be overkill there. The **DIRECTOR/owner** dashboard itself remains unchanged.

7. Admin Overview — Housekeeping & Dashboard

7.1 Dashboard overview missing the room/housekeeping summary breakdown

Problem: The admin overview showed a single “tasks in queue” number rather than the requested breakdown of rooms by status.

Solution: The admin overview now shows a **Housekeeping summary** strip with **Clean rooms**, **Dirty rooms** and rooms **Under maintenance** (each with a proportional bar). The backend overview endpoint now returns the full room-status breakdown (total, available, occupied, cleaning, maintenance, dirty) to feed it.

8. Reports (from “Reports” review — carried into this round)

All 11 items from the Reports review remain fixed and are now printable to the till or A4 as appropriate. Stock Adjustment report, department and outlet filters, and branded Ezee-style report headers (logo + hotel name + title + period + “Printed by”) are all live.

Summary of Deployments

- Frontend (mrk-hotels.com) — deployed and **ready** on Netlify.
- Backend API — deployed and **succeeded** on Laravel Cloud.